ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 8 · SET 02

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The ancient Indian science of plant and tree care, formalised in the 10th century CE in a text by Surapala, is called —

(A) Dhanurveda (B) Vrikshayurveda
(C) Arthashastra (D) Sushruta Samhita

> **Ans: (B)** Vriksha = tree; ayurveda = science of life/health.

(ii) In which year did Sikkim become India's first 100 per cent organic state?

(A) 2006 (B) 2011 (C) 2016 (D) 2021

> **Ans: (C)** All of Sikkim's farmland was certified organic in 2016.

(iii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option.

1. Formation of the Khalsa by Guru Gobind Singh
2. First Battle of Panipat
3. Battle of Saraighat
4. Second Battle of Panipat

(A) 4, 2, 3, 1 (B) 2, 3, 4, 1 (C) 2, 4, 1, 3 (D) 2, 4, 3, 1

> **Ans: (D)** Correct order: First Battle of Panipat (1526) → Second Battle of Panipat (1556) → Battle of Saraighat (1671) → Formation of the Khalsa by Guru Gobind Singh (1699)

(iv) Which Delhi ruler called himself 'Sikander Sani' (the second Alexander) on his coins?

(A) Muhammad bin Tughlaq (B) Qutub-ud-din Aibak
(C) Ala-ud-din Khilji (D) Sher Shah Suri

> **Ans: (C)** Ala-ud-din Khilji also repelled several Mongol invasions.

(v) The Ahom kingdom of Assam raised labour and soldiers through a system in which every able-bodied man served the state. It was called the —

(A) Paik system (B) Iqta system
(C) Jagir system (D) Mansabdari system

> **Ans: (A)** Service in exchange for land rights let the Ahoms keep a large force without a permanent army.

(vi) Where was Chhatrapati Shivaji crowned with full Vedic rites in 1674?

(A) Pune (B) Pratapgad (C) Sindhudurg (D) Raigad

> **Ans: (D)** He took the title 'Shri Raja Shiva Chhatrapati'.

(vii) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: Tarabai, the widow of Rajaram, was the architect of the northward Maratha expansion.
Statement II: Peshwa Bajirao I and Nanasaheb Peshwa drove the Maratha expansion only up to the Deccan and never beyond it.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** The Peshwas were instrumental in the pan-Indian expansion of the Marathas.

(viii) The Battle of Colachel (1741), in which a Dutch force was decisively defeated, was fought against the kingdom of —

(A) Mysore (B) Travancore (C) Hyderabad (D) Bengal

> **Ans: (B)** King Marthanda Varma's forces defeated the Dutch.

(ix) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.
Assertion (A): The Great Rebellion of 1857 failed to end British rule.
Reason (R): The rebels lacked a unified command and a consistent strategy.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** Both are correct; R explains why the rebellion failed.

(x) Identify the correct match.

(A) Santhal Rebellion – 1831–32 (B) Santhal Rebellion – 1855–56
(C) Santhal Rebellion – 1859–62 (D) Santhal Rebellion – 1806

> **Ans: (B)** The Santhals under Sidhu and Kanhu rose against moneylenders and landlords in 1855–56.

(xi) How many seats in the Lok Sabha are reserved for Scheduled Castes?

(A) 47 (B) 131 (C) 412 (D) 84

> **Ans: (D)** 84 seats are reserved for SC, 47 for ST; the remaining 412 are general.

(xii) What fraction of the members of the Rajya Sabha retire every two years?

(A) One-third (B) One-half (C) One-fourth (D) One-fifth

> **Ans: (A)** Members serve six-year terms; one-third retire every two years, so it is a permanent house.

(xiii) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: Parliament of India meets in three sessions every year — Budget, Monsoon and Winter.
Statement II: Money Bills can be introduced only in the Rajya Sabha.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** Money Bills originate only in the Lok Sabha.

(xiv) From 2014, Indian law requires eligible companies to spend a share of their average profits on Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR). What share was fixed?

(A) 1 per cent (B) 5 per cent (C) 2 per cent (D) 10 per cent

> **Ans: (C)** CSR mandate: 2% of average profits (2014).

(xv) Which of the following goods is produced by a capital-intensive process?

(A) Handloom cloth (B) Wheat from a small farm
(C) Handmade pottery (D) Semiconductor chips

> **Ans: (D)** Chips and satellites need large investment in machinery and technology; agriculture and handicrafts are labour-intensive.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Give any two reasons for the political instability of the Delhi Sultanate.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Almost two out of three sultans seized power by eliminating their predecessor
> - A sultan's average reign was barely nine years
> - Constant invasions (Mongols, Timur) and revolts weakened the state (any two, 1 mark each)

O R

2.(B) What was Muhammad bin Tughlaq's token currency? Why did it fail?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Cheap copper coins were declared equal in value to silver or gold coins — 1 mark
> - It created confusion in trade and encouraged counterfeiting, causing economic decline — 1 mark

3. Differentiate between ecosystem functions and ecosystem services.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Ecosystem functions — the inherent ways Nature works, e.g. a forest filters water and prevents soil erosion — 1 mark
> - Ecosystem services — the benefits humans receive from these functions, e.g. clean water, protected farmland — 1 mark

4.(A) What is NOTA? State its use.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - NOTA means 'None Of The Above' — 1 mark
> - It allows voters to reject all candidates; it does not change the result but sends a message — 1 mark

O R

4.(B) What is the Model Code of Conduct? State one rule in it.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A set of rules for free and fair elections, agreed by major political parties and enforced by the Election Commission — 1 mark
> - Any one rule: no new government schemes that may influence voters; peaceful campaigning; no bribery — 1 mark

5. State any two ways in which the Judiciary checks the Legislature and the Executive.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - It interprets laws and ensures laws made by the Legislature do not violate the Constitution
> - It ensures that actions of the Executive respect the Constitution
> - As custodian of the Constitution it keeps every organ within its limits (any two, 1 mark each)

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Explain any three features of the Ahom kingdom.

> **Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):**
> - Migrated from present-day Myanmar in the 13th century and formed a kingdom in the Brahmaputra Valley
> - Resisted expansion during both the Sultanate and Mughal periods
> - The paik system supplied labour and soldiers in exchange for land rights
> - Used knowledge of forests, hills and rivers and guerrilla tactics; won the Battle of Saraighat (1671) under Lachit Borphukan
> - Assimilated local culture and encouraged agriculture and diverse faiths

O R

6.(B) Explain any three features of the Rajput resistance led by Maharana Pratap.

> **Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):**
> - As ruler of Mewar he refused to accept Mughal suzerainty
> - At Haldighati (1576) the Mughals had the upper hand, but he escaped
> - He then waged guerrilla warfare from the Aravalli hills for years
> - The Bhils supported him as archers and guides who knew the terrain; the Mewar emblem honours them

7.(A) Describe any three features of the Maratha navy.

> **Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):**
> - Founded by Shivaji (about 1657) to secure the west-coast resources — a revolutionary step
> - Neither the Bijapur Sultanate nor the Mughals had a full-time naval force
> - Naval forts such as Sindhudurg were built
> - Kanhoji Angre won many battles in the 18th century using geography and tactics; the Marathas demanded passes from Europeans

O R

7.(B) Explain any three features of the Maratha judicial system.

> **Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):**
> - An efficient system, remarkable for moderate use of capital punishment
> - The panchayat (local gathering of officials and prominent men) delivered justice
> - Appeal could be made to a Maratha chief if the verdict was unsatisfactory
> - The kotwal (police) kept law and order in towns such as Pune and Indore

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain the policy of Akbar towards Rajputs and people of other faiths. Mention any five points.

> **Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):**
> - Sulh-i-kul — 'peace with all' — tolerance of all faiths
> - Marriage alliances with Rajput princesses
> - Welcomed Rajput and regional leaders into his court and gave Hindus high posts
> - Abolished the jizya (and the pilgrimage tax)
> - Held interfaith dialogues
> - Set up a house of translation at Fatehpur Sikri — Mahabharata (Razmnama), Ramayana, Gita, Panchatantra translated into Persian

O R

8.(B) Explain the effects of the policies of Aurangzeb on the Mughal Empire. Mention any five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Empire reached its greatest extent, but with constant rebellions
- Spent his last 25 years fighting in the Deccan; huge armies drained the treasury
- Reimposed the jizya and pilgrimage tax abolished by Akbar
- Ordered destruction of temples (e.g. Banaras, Mathura, Somnath); banned music and dance at court
- Persecuted Sikhs (Guru Tegh Bahadur), Sufis and other sects; provoked Jat, Sikh, Rajput and Maratha resistance
- Rapid decline of Mughal power after his death in 1707

9. 'Colonial rule led to the dismantling of India's traditional systems.' Support the statement with the help of five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Village self-government and regional administrative systems were replaced by a centralised bureaucracy meant for tax collection and order
- Customary laws were ignored; British courts were costly, slow and in a foreign language
- Macaulay's Minute (1835) promoted English education; traditional schools — pathashalas, madrasas — slowly disappeared
- Education aimed at producing clerks 'English in taste, opinions, morals and intellect'
- Indigenous industries like textiles declined; economy turned into supplier of raw materials
- Railways and telegraph served imperial needs and were paid by Indian taxes

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

Cement is essential for houses, schools, bridges and airports, but its production is among the most polluting industries. Its fine dust damages the lungs of humans and animals, settles on leaves and lowers crop yields, and pollutes soil and water. The Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) has therefore issued guidelines for cement factories. Builders are also turning to old and new alternatives — stone, mud, plant-based materials and bricks made from recycled waste plastic.

(10.1) Which body has issued pollution-control guidelines for cement factories?

The Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB).

(10.2) How does cement dust harm crops?

It settles on leaves and reduces the yield.

(10.3) Suggest two ways of reducing the harm caused by cement production and use.

Any two (1 mark each): follow CPCB guidelines to cut dust; use alternatives such as stone, mud, plant-based materials; use recycled materials from waste plastic.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Guru Tegh Bahadur, the ninth Sikh Guru, was approached in 1675 by Kashmiri Pandits who were being persecuted. He stood by them. Emperor Aurangzeb ordered him to give up his faith, and when he refused, he was publicly beheaded in Chandni Chowk, Delhi. His son, Guru Gobind Singh, the tenth and last Guru, established the Khalsa in 1699 as a martial brotherhood committed to justice, equality and defence of the faith.

(11.1) Who was the ninth Sikh Guru mentioned in the passage?

> Guru Tegh Bahadur.

(11.2) In which year was the Khalsa established?

> 1699.

(11.3) Why did Guru Tegh Bahadur accept martyrdom?

> (1) He stood by the Kashmiri Pandits who sought protection from persecution; (1) he refused to give up his faith/convert when ordered by Aurangzeb — upholding freedom of belief.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In India, elected members are the voters' own representatives. The President is elected by an Electoral College made up of the elected Members of Parliament and the elected Members of the state Legislative Assemblies, including those of Delhi and Puducherry. The vote is by the single transferable vote. The nominated members of the Rajya Sabha and of the state assemblies, and the members of Legislative Councils, do not take part.

(12.1) Which two bodies' elected members form the Electoral College for electing the President?

> Parliament (MPs) and the State Legislative Assemblies (MLAs, including Delhi and Puducherry).

(12.2) Name one group that does not vote in the Presidential election.

> Any one: nominated members of the Rajya Sabha; nominated members of State Assemblies; members of Legislative Councils.

(12.3) Why are nominated members kept out of the Presidential election?

> (1) To ensure that only directly elected representatives of the people vote; (1) this maintains the democratic legitimacy of the election.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Ratna wants to start a small restaurant. She rents a shop (land) and buys ovens and tables (capital). She hires cooks and waiters (labour), and she herself decides the menu and takes the risk of the venture (entrepreneurship). She uses a mobile app to take orders and accept UPI payments. Within a year, her restaurant is known for its trained staff and consistent quality.

(13.1) Which factor of production does Ratna herself represent?

> Entrepreneurship.

(13.2) Name the technology mentioned in the passage that helps her business.

> A mobile app for orders / UPI payments.

(13.3) How can Ratna improve the human capital of her staff? Give two ways.

> Any two (1 mark each): training and skill development; education; healthcare/safe working conditions; encouraging a culture of hard work and continuous improvement.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Fatehpur Sikri
(II) Chittorgarh
(III) Pratapgad Fort
(IV) Bailadila iron ore mine
(V) Neyveli lignite field
(VI) Konark

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Fatehpur Sikri located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Chittorgarh located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Pratapgad Fort located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bailadila iron ore mine located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Neyveli lignite field located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Konark located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Fatehpur Sikri — **Uttar Pradesh**
- (II) Chittorgarh — **Rajasthan**
- (III) Pratapgad Fort — **Maharashtra**
- (IV) Bailadila iron ore mine — **Chhattisgarh**
- (V) Neyveli lignite field — **Tamil Nadu**
- (VI) Konark — **Odisha**

